Rainline
COMMUNITY NETWORK BULLETIN

NOVEMBER 1998 ISSUE 04

FROM THE NOTICEBOARD

The reading room

We moved the reading room into the old post office on Alder Street. Two folding tables, a borrowed printer and a box of back issues are all it took. The rain on the skylight is louder than the printer.

This month the shelves hold six local newsletters and a binder of public meeting notes. Readers can borrow an issue overnight. Write its title and your first name on the slip inside the cover.

On Saturday we will sort the loose clippings by year. Bring a pencil, and leave room in the last binder for the pieces nobody can date.

READING ROOM HOURS

Saturday / 10 am to 2 pm

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FROM THE EQUIPMENT DESK

Two lines after dark

The second dial-up line opens at seven each evening. The first line stays available all day for readers collecting mail and checking the community calendar.

A volunteer logged the busy signals for a week in the spiral notebook beside the modem. Most callers who tried again after supper got through on their second attempt.

Each shift starts with a test call and a message to the local bulletin board. If the connection drops, pencil the time in the notebook. We will compare the entries at the next work party.

EQUIPMENT LOG

Second line / 7 pm to 11 pm

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FROM THE MACHINE ROOM

The Friday shelf

Tape rotation begins after the Friday mail run. The volunteer on duty marks the date on a paper sleeve and puts the cartridge in the dry cupboard above the spare cables.

One cartridge travels home in a padded envelope. Another stays on the shelf for fast restores. The labels use the week number so nobody has to guess which copy came first.

Last week we restored a single issue of the bulletin onto the spare machine. The photographs and the masthead came back together. A note on the sleeve records who checked the copy.

RESTORE CHECK

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One saved issue / one spare machine
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